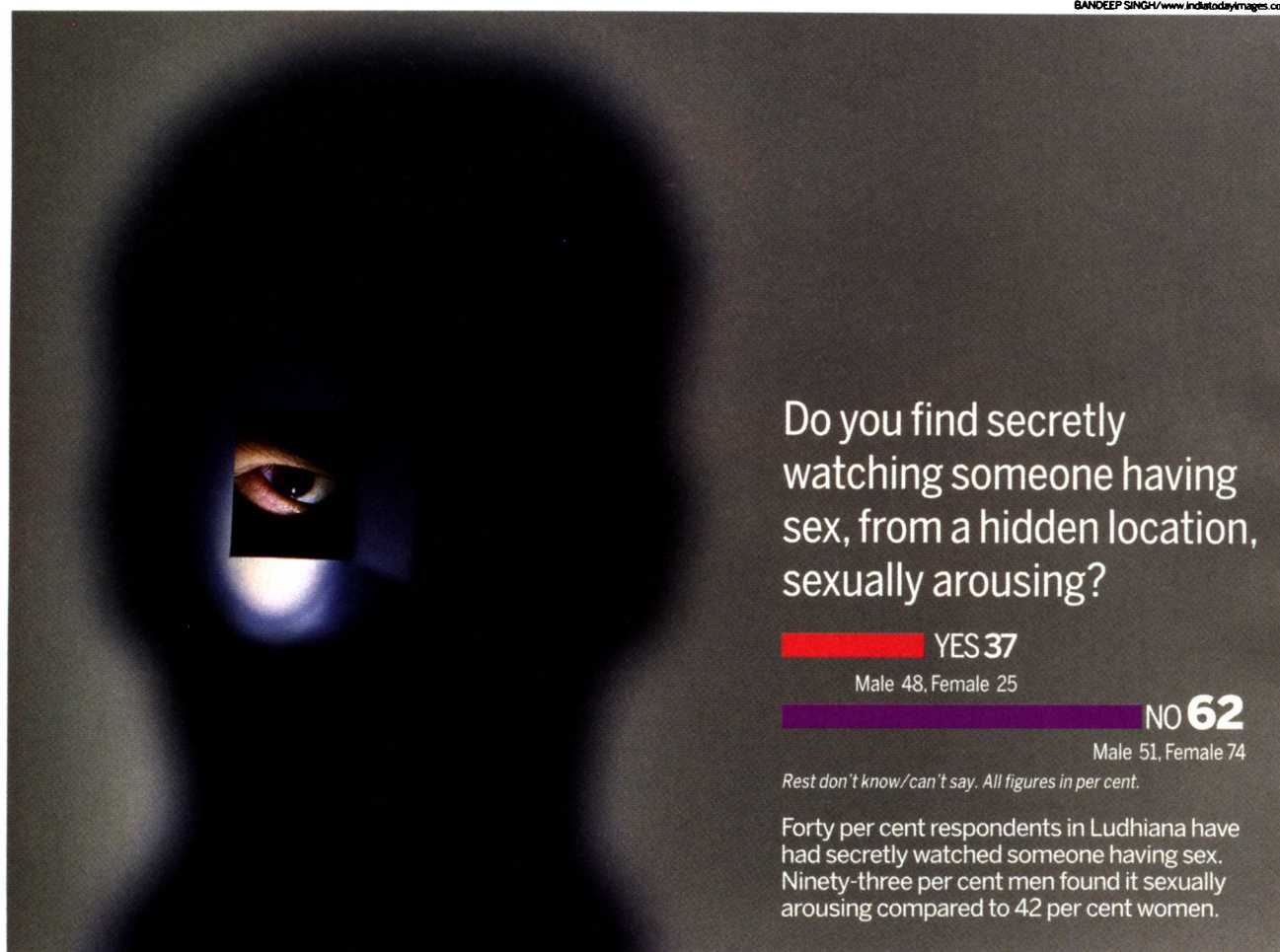




of note: Ludhiana records the highest number of men who fantasised about MMS sex; one in five of them claimed that they have seen MMS sex videos of their friends/relatives though not a very high number have recorded their own; of those who have, however, a very high number (80 per cent) have shared their videos with others and uploaded them on the Internet. Ludhiana then has the highest figures for peeping toms, whether by inclination or action, crossing 90 per cent in fantasising about arousal sparked by both voyeuristic and exhibitionist exertions. We must remember, of course, that such figures for Ludhiana have significant impact, then, on the averages that are finally calculated for the general pool.

Across regions and cities, there is a sharp divide between men and women in fantasising about sexual arousal caused either by watching others secretly or in knowingly being watched. Men find greater arousal in being watched by women during their own sexual activity (70 per cent) rather than by men, the conviction being highest in the south: in Bangalore, almost all the men are excited by the prospect of performing sex for female viewers/voyeurs. In contrast, only 30 per cent of women in the survey are aroused by voyeurs, but then equally by men and women. This survey reveals quite definitively that men fantasise far more

about being either/both voyeurs and exhibitionists than women do. But through it all, one wonders about the sexual preferences of both male and female respondents; it would be rather quaint of us to assume, after all, that all desiring is heterosexual. Indeed, especially in the context of fantasy, revelations to the contrary might well have been stunning.

Is one to infer from this data that voyeurism and/or exhibitionism as sexual behaviours are rampant in metros and small towns across India in 2009? Not quite. What is truly significant is that India—big town, small town, uptown, downtown—has begun to fantasise seriously about traditionally aberrant sexual practices, and has even begun to indulge in such fantasies, jettisoned into future-fantastic as it has been by the wonder of a consumerist, globalised modernity embodied in, and infinitely emboldened by, a single, tiny, hand-held piece of video-recording equipment. Are all Indians turning overnight into voyeurs and exhibitionists, then? As E.M. Forster had pronounced in an entirely different context in the closing moments of *A Passage to India*, "Not now. Not yet." Ominous. Or promising. Take it as you will.

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